



Tamil Nadu State Policy for Women 2024

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Tamil Nadu State Policy for Women – 2024

I. Preamble

Women empowerment can be defined to mean promoting women's sense of worth, their right to determine their own choices and ability to influence social change for themselves and for others.

In accordance with the vision of the Hon'ble Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu, *the State is a pioneer not only in economic and other related areas but also in social justice, equality and women empowerment.*

The Hon'ble Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu while participating in the Grama Sabha of Pappampatti Village in Madurai District sets the mandate for this policy through the following pledge:

"I will treat everyone with dignity and equality, prevent and file complaint against female infanticide, foeticide and child marriages. I take an oath that I shall not tolerate sexual harassment, and I pledge to stand up for victims of sexual harassment and take action against the perpetrators".

Moreover Women's equality and empowerment (Sustainable Development Goal 5 (SDG5)) is one of the seventeen Sustainable Development Goals and is integral to all dimensions of inclusive and sustainable development. Empowering women is key to economic growth, political stability and social transformation.

The Social Welfare and Nutritious Meal Programme Department was renamed as the Social Welfare and Women Empowerment Department to provide additional thrust for affirmative action related to gender.

II. Vision

In order to ensure a sustainable tomorrow, the State of Tamil Nadu will ensure social justice for all and provide women, access to their rightful entitlements, enable them to lead a harmonious and peaceful life with equitable opportunities to realise their true potential and aspirations.

Mission

The State of Tamil Nadu would provide a safe, secure, healthy, aspirational and enabling environment to empower women in the State, through operational synergy and convergence amongst stakeholders to achieve the developmental goals for women. The State envisages to raise the status of women through awareness, education, gainful employment and capacity building initiatives.

Objectives

The broad objectives of this policy framework is to enable access to services such as health, education and employment, enabling conducive conditions that restructure gender norms and behavior linked changes, zero tolerance against any kind of discrimination, abuse and violence against women and empower women to break gender stereotyping and enable them to excel in any sector.

The policy would be implemented over a period of 10 years with the following objectives:

- Establish a gender-sensitive education system and reduce the dropout rate among girls.
- Improve health and nutritional status of adolescent girls and women.
- Increase women's participation in the workforce.
- Ensure safe and women-friendly workplaces both in organized and unorganized sectors.
- Handhold women start-ups and women-led micro enterprises.
- Promote digital literacy to bridge the digital gender gap and support women for remunerative placements.
- Reduce the skill gap among women in the industrial sector by providing training and capacity building.
- Enhance access to institutional financial tools and availability to women.
- Encourage active participation of women in political space.

III. Stakeholders

The Social Welfare and Women Empowerment Department will be the anchor department in monitoring the implementation of this policy.

The key stakeholders in implementing the Policy are all Government departments, Educational Organizations, Academicians, Banks, Industries, Research and Training Institutions, Civil Society Organizations, Rural and Urban Local Bodies and Community based organizations.

This Policy covers the entire women population of Tamil Nadu with special focus on the following categories of Women:

- Women-headed households (single women, widows and deserted women)
- Women from oppressed communities
- Women engaged in vulnerable occupations (sex workers, rag pickers, conservancy workers, street vendors, head-load vendors, beggars, etc.)
- Women working in rice mills, brick kilns as bonded labour
- Differently abled Women
- Elderly women
- Women in the informal sector (domestic workers, construction workers, daily wage works, salt-pan workers, agricultural labourers, and casual labourers from different sectors, etc.)
- Women in the formal sector

IV. Present Scenario

Tamil Nadu is pioneer in social justice, equality and women empowerment and stands in the forefront through its various welfare schemes. The various indicators and gender related data depict the advantageous position of the State in comparison to the national average.

Through an exclusive women's policy, the State intends to further narrow down the gender gap existing in the society by addressing the challenges such as gender disparity, social stereotyping, domestic violence, abuse, discrimination, etc.

V. Implementation Approach

The implementation approach for the policy will be categorised in following spheres of Intervention:

1. Social Empowerment
2. Economic Empowerment
3. Political Empowerment
4. Emotional and Mental wellbeing

1. Social Empowerment

Social empowerment enables women to act individually and collectively to bring about changes in social relationships and institutions so that women have control over their lives, take independent decisions and have access to equitable opportunities.

1.1. Education and Research

According to All India Survey on Higher Education, Tamil Nadu has 50.5% male enrolment and 49.5% female enrolment with gender parity index of 0.99. This has been possible due to the State's welfare schemes such as free school education, free text books, uniforms, nutritious meal programmes, post matric scholarships etc. Such measures shall be further strengthened through the following interventions:

- 1.1.1 Eliminate gender stereotyping and gender bias between girls and boys that are prevalent in the family, home, schools, colleges and in work places.
- 1.1.2 Reduce dropouts among girl children in High School and Higher Secondary Schools.
- 1.1.3 Encourage schools to provide counselling facilities for girls regarding career guidance, legal awareness about consent, age for marriage etc.
- 1.1.4 Train teachers in schools and colleges in counseling skills and conduct refresher programmes.
- 1.1.5 Encourage girl students to pursue research, especially in STEM courses. (Science, Technology, Engineering, Mathematics)

- 1.1.6 Encourage girl students to participate in outdoor and extra curricular activities such as yoga, dance, sports, martial arts etc. for their mental and physical wellbeing.
- 1.1.7 Skill training especially upskilling or reskilling courses for enabling women for lateral entry or re-entry after career break.
- 1.1.8 Provide digital literacy through Community Resource Person (CRP) / Community Professionals (CP) in the Community.
- 1.1.9 Provide livelihood skills for children especially girl children who are in juvenile homes and children homes for their future employment.

1.2. Health and Sanitation

The State shall take earnest steps to ensure quality and essential health care services to women through various interventions:

- 1.2.1 Improve sex ratio at birth.
- 1.2.2 Awareness about personal hygiene and menstrual hygiene to adolescent girls and women and availability of sanitary napkins and proper restroom facilities in Schools, Colleges, work places and public places.
- 1.2.3 Annual Regular Health check up for girls at school / colleges and for women at work place.
- 1.2.4 Provision of various nutritional interventions for pregnant and lactating mothers in the form of Ante-Natal Care (ANC) and Post Natal Care (PNC).
- 1.2.5 Ensure women's reproductive rights such as the right to exercise choices in contraception, family planning methods, right to bodily autonomy including the right to legal and safe abortion
- 1.2.6 Provide female friendly rest room in Public Places, Government Offices, Highways, Tollgates, etc.
- 1.2.7 Special focus to ensure the mental wellbeing of women by addressing the mental health issues of all categories of women.

- 1.2.8 Strengthen geriatric services for women, including preventive, curative and rehabilitative healthcare in line with Maintenance and Welfare of Parents and Senior Citizens Act, 2007.

1.2.a Nutrition

Nutrition shall be accorded utmost priority as women are at high risk for nutritional deficiencies and hence shall be provided nutritional literacy in all stages of their life cycle. Interventions and services for addressing the intergenerational cycle of under-nutrition, with focus on nutritional care for the first 1000 days of the child from conception shall be strengthened and duly monitored at the highest level in the State.

Improving the nutrition and health status of adolescent girls shall be accorded special focus and suitable strategies to end intra-household discrimination in nutritional matters with regard to girls and women shall be devised. Adolescent girls shall be engaged in schools under life skill education programmes that include physical, developmental, general health and hygiene including sexual health, self-defense, culture, arts, etc.

Data on weight at birth by Sex and on prevalence of nutritional deficiency in Children sex-wise (district wise data) will be collected for collation and periodical tracking of nutritional status of children by Health and ICDS departments.

The service delivery of Integrated Child Development Services Scheme (ICDS) will be strengthened to ensure malnutrition free Tamil Nadu in children, adolescent girls, pregnant and lactating mothers.

1.3. Inter-Sectionality

- 1.3.1 The State shall ensure access to Government schemes entitlements and benefits to all sections of women and children in the society.

Priority shall be, however accorded to all vulnerable women and children such as destitute, women belonging to minorities, differently-abled, deserted women, widows, HIV positive women, women-headed households, migrant

women workers, women in need of geriatric care, elderly women, etc.

- 1.3.2 As per census 2011, in India 5.6 crore are widowed women (4.6% of total population). Experts opine that the increase in life expectancy particularly in women is the main reason for the jumping trend of widowed population and is a global phenomenon that women live longer than men. Among States, Kerala (6.7%) and TN (6.4%) have a significant percentage of their respective population as widows. States with significant elderly population have more widows.

In this context, as a pioneer initiative to address the issues related to widows and destitute women, on 02.09.2022 Tamil Nadu Widows and Destitute Women Welfare Board has been constituted with 14 non-official members and 10 official members. The Board is chaired by Hon'ble Minister for SW&WE Department.

The main mandate of the Board is to extend services in specific to widows, destitute, deserted, vulnerable and unmarried women, in terms of promoting their education, health, employment, skill training, livelihood opportunities, psycho social counselling services, safe, secured and dignified living. The various welfare services extended by different departments and agencies will be coordinated and facilitated upon through the Board activities.

- 1.3.3 Special care services will also be provided for gender non-conforming adolescents, intersex adolescents, children of convicts, children of sex workers, children of migrant workers, transgender persons, etc.

1.4 Elimination of Violence

The State adopts a zero tolerance policy against any form of violence, abuse and discrimination against women and take up the following initiatives:

- 1.4.1 Convergence of the initiatives and steps to address all forms of violence against women including sex selective termination of pregnancy, denial of education, child marriage, domestic violence, sexual abuse etc.
- 1.4.2 Creation of a common platform to integrate the existing helplines, one stop centres, shelter homes, legal forums, counselling and support mechanisms available to ensure every case of gender-based violence reaches its logical conclusion.
- 1.4.3 Providing gender friendly environment in educational institutions and work places and ensure strict action in cases of violence against women and girls.
- 1.4.4 Ensuring safety of women at work place in line with the Prevention of Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013 by strengthening the Internal Complaints Committee to function effectively and responsively.
- 1.4.5 Tamil Nadu State Commission for Women will take action on complaints received from women on issues like domestic violence, dowry abuse, sexual harassment, polygamy, sexual violence at workplace, human trafficking, complaints of vulnerable women and creates awareness among people through public events such as awareness programs, review meetings, seminars, cultural programs and marathons to bring about change in the community.
- 1.4.6 Women Helpline 181, functioning 24x7 hours, will provide immediate and emergency response during a need or crisis and thereby improve the safety of women and children. Women Helpline also provides information about the laws, existing schemes and Government programs related to women empowerment and protection.
- 1.4.7 Elder Helpline 14567 will provide rescue services, Information on Old Age Homes, Senior Citizen Welfare Schemes, Psycho Social Counselling, Legal guidance on the provision of the Maintenance and Welfare of Parents and Senior Citizens Act, 2007.

1.5 Social Security

Tamil Nadu has been a leading State in providing various social security measures through its pioneering schemes for the vulnerable sections of the society including women. The State shall ensure access to these welfare measures in terms of availability, accessibility and adequacy for the needy.

- 1.5.1 Encourage the formation/strengthening of gender clubs to increase awareness on gender equality, legal rights, educational opportunities, career choices and welfare schemes of the Government.
- 1.5.2 The State shall strengthen the existing adolescent girl groups at the community level to provide a platform to identify challenges, voice their concerns and find evidence-based solutions in a safe environment.
- 1.5.3 The State shall take adequate measures for poverty alleviation by ensuring social safety nets reach the economically vulnerable families.
- 1.5.4 The State shall take steps to create awareness about the welfare measures and schemes such as free school uniform, higher education assurance scheme (Pudhumai Penn scheme), Chief Minister Breakfast scheme, Nutritious Meal Programme, Reservation and tuition fee waiver for Government school students in professional courses and marriage assistance schemes.
- 1.5.5 The State shall ensure that the Girl Children fostered through Government children homes will be eligible to avail benefits available under various Government schemes such as first graduate scholarship, marriage assistance, skill training etc.

1.6. Legal

- 1.6.1 The State through the State Law Commission will facilitate periodic legal review and administrative reforms to ensure that the gaps in the existing laws, policies and programmes are addressed.

- 1.6.2 The State shall put in place a mechanism to fast track the cases related to Gender Based Violence (GBV).
- 1.6.3 Strengthening various services such as One Stop Centres, Women Helpline to provide legal assistance to women in need and distress.

1.7 Media

- 1.7.1 Gender parity in the mass media such as print and electronic media, advertising world, film sector and news media shall be encouraged.
- 1.7.2 Encourage gender sensitive and non-discriminatory portrayal of women in all forms of media.
- 1.7.3 The State shall put in place safeguards to protect the dignity and safety of women through its cybercrime interventions.

1.8. Infrastructure

- 1.8.1 The State shall ensure inclusive differently-abled women friendly and senior citizen friendly infrastructure in public places.
- 1.8.2 Ensure women friendly and safe public transportation system.
- 1.8.3 Improve the infrastructure facilities in the existing transit homes for women and establishment of need based transit homes with the support of local bodies.
- 1.8.4 Promote establishment of Creche facilities at work places.
- 1.8.5 The Government will strive to ensure that Developers/Builders/Contractors of large construction sites of floor area more than 20,000 sq.mt to provide adequate facilities such as creche, mobile school health care facility and paramedical facilities for construction workers (women) and their children at the construction site.

2. Economic Empowerment

A meaningful and gainful participation of women in economic activities is integral for achieving greater security and stability in the country. An economically empowered women invest more in their families and communities, spurring economic growth and creating more stable societies. The State shall therefore explore all possibilities and opportunities including flexi timings in the various job sectors in order to create a sustainable livelihood for women. Various initiatives and schemes undertaken by the Government shall continue to be evolved and implemented for the economic empowerment of women in the State.

2.a.Tamil Nadu Corporation for Development of Women (TNCDW)

The Tamil Nadu Corporation for Development of Women (TNCDW) was established in 1983 by the Government of Tamil Nadu with the primary objective of social and economic empowerment of women through education, employment, economic development and self-reliance.

The Self-Help Group (SHG) movement in Tamil Nadu was nurtured by TNCDW for the overall development of rural women by instilling a sense of bonding and confidence through a wide range of capacity building activities, forming Community Based Organizations (CBOs) like the Panchayat Level Federations (PLFs), Block Level Federations (BLFs) etc., facilitating bank credit for income generation through economic activities and various poverty alleviation programmes.

A total of 3.95 lakhs SHGs are active in rural and urban areas of Tamil Nadu. In addition to this, SHGs are also formed and supported by various Government and Non-Government Organisations (NGOs).

2.b. Self Help Group (SHG) Movement

The seeds of the Self Help Group (SHG) concept for the Socio-economic empowerment of women was sown in 1989 at Dharmapuri. The SHG concept gained momentum under International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD) assisted project and with the introduction of the Mahalir Thittam in 1996, it was gradually extended to other districts and by the year 2000, all districts including Chennai

were covered under the scheme. Due to the strong SHG base created in the State, the Swarnaajayanthi Gram Swarozgar Yojana (SGSY) a Centrally Sponsored Scheme launched in 1999 to address rural poverty with focus on SHG was effectively implemented for economic improvement of the rural poor. During the year 2022-2023, 4,39,349 SHGs have been assisted with a credit linkage of Rs.25,022.19 crore with an average loan size per SHG is Rs.5.68 lakh.

2.c. Poverty Alleviation and Livelihood Missions

The Government of Tamil Nadu is a model welfare State which focuses on inclusive socio-economic development through multivarious schemes that provide opportunities for disadvantaged people to access the benefits of programmes and projects and improve their quality of life. The Rural Development and Panchayat Raj Department is vested with the important mandate of poverty alleviation and socio-economic empowerment of the poor, marginalized and vulnerable families through livelihood promotion programmes anchored by the Tamil Nadu Corporation for Development of Women and the World Bank assisted "Vaazhndhu Kaattuvom" Project now continued as Tamil Nadu Rural Transformation Project.

2.1 Agriculture and Allied Sectors

In Tamil Nadu, majority of economically productive women are engaged as agricultural labourers. Despite their large presence and contribution to rural economy, their work is limited to less skilled jobs such as sowing, transplanting, weeding, harvesting etc. Further, Women cultivators are very less in number and do not have proper access to inputs (seed, fertilizer), credit facility, organized markets, advanced technologies such as use of drudgery reduction technologies etc. The State shall therefore take necessary measures to support women in agriculture.

- 2.1.1 The State shall take steps to remove occupational segregation and gender pay gap in agricultural activities and allied sectors.

- 2.1.2 Concerted efforts shall be taken to ensure that benefits of training, extension activities in crop cultivation, kitchen garden/ nutri-veg garden, social forestry, horticulture, dairy development, livestock rearing, poultry, fisheries, backyard farming etc., reach the women.
- 2.1.3 Women farmers and agricultural workers will be encouraged in increasing the production of vermicompost, microbial fertilizers, bio manure, bio pesticides, establishment of nurseries.
- 2.1.4 Encourage formation of Women Producer Collectives / Farm cooperatives along with adequate training and handholding support for sustainability.
- 2.1.5 Promote awareness and access to information on Government schemes, subsidies and grants, availability of inputs such as seeds, fertilizers, pesticides, micro irrigation, bank linkage/ credit services and market support.

2.2.Skilling & Employment

The State shall focus on skilling programs to overcome the challenges of the women in the work force and enable them to secure and retain the jobs.

- 2.2.1 Convergence with existing flagship Government skilling programs to enable both wage and self employment.
- 2.2.2 Identify women friendly sectors, sub sectors and trades for skilling that have potential for employment and self employment.
- 2.2.3 Skilling intervention on activities prominent regionally and develop locally relevant community managed skill training in sectors with market demand.
- 2.2.4 Identify informal sectors with high employment opportunities for skilling such as weaving, jewellery making, pottery, electrician, masonry, home appliances and two-wheeler repairs.
- 2.2.5 Exclusive job melas for women shall be organized in specific sectors in collaboration with industries.

- 2.2.6 On the job apprenticeship and skilling intervention in collaboration with industry partners.
- 2.2.7 Internship opportunities and career readiness programs for final year and fresh women graduates shall be organised in relevant sectors.
- 2.2.8 Establish a robust system for monitoring, assessment, certification, placement services and post placement tracking for skilling interventions.
- 2.2.9 Industrialization and urbanization have opened avenues for employment of young women in the cities and towns and hence they are compelled to stay away from their homes. This increases their need to find safe and secure housing accommodation in the cities at a relatively affordable cost. Working Women Hostels are maintained through Government for protection and security of the employed women.
- 2.2.10 Tamil Nadu Working Women Hostels Corporation Limited (TNWWHCL) as a Special Purpose Vehicle (SPV) established in 2019, undertakes required infrastructure development, management and maintenance of working women's hostels, crèches, senior citizen homes and child care institutions. Retrofitting and upgradation of existing hostels are taken up in order to improve the service delivery by providing adequate facilities for a safe and comfortable stay to encourage more women to enter into the workforce. Construction of new hostels with the funding from State Government and Tamil Nadu Shelter Fund of Tamil Nadu Infrastructure Fund Management Corporation has been commenced to provide a new professional, self sustainable cross subsidy hostel model.
- 2.2.11 Free Bus Travel for Women - Safe commutation of women enables their independent mobility and empowerment. This has helped women towards pursuing their higher education, travelling to their work place by themselves etc. Thus, daily expenses of transportation has been saved and spent on other essential expenses like food, clothing, education etc.

2.3 Unorganized sector

The State shall give utmost priority to address the issues faced by women working in unorganized sector such as pay disparity, poor working conditions, lack of proper hygiene and sanitation, excessive seasonality of employment, long working hours, occupational hazards and exploitations etc.

- 2.3.1 Women working in the unorganized sectors shall be enrolled in the labour welfare boards that would offer them the required support in terms of social security and safety nets.
- 2.3.2 The State Nodal centre for Occupational Health and Safety of Unorganized workers (SNC- OSH) shall monitor the wellbeing of women working in hazardous employment.
- 2.3.3 Creating awareness about health and hygiene, nutrition, One stop centres, legal rights and women helpline.

2.4 Banking and insurance

The banking sector plays a critical role in spearheading the financial inclusion of women in the Indian economy. There have been, and still exist, several socio-cultural barriers for the true financial inclusion of women.

- 2.4.1 The State shall enable women to access the formal banking system and develop a strategy for the financial institutions to address the significant gender gap by removing the constraints for accessing private finance.
- 2.4.2 The State shall encourage the banks to provide more support to micro, small and medium size enterprises (MSMEs) specifically run by women by way of collateral free loan, low interest rates, interest subvention, simplified banking procedures, women centric or financial schemes for women.
- 2.4.3 The State shall consider providing subsidy for select categories based on the prompt repayment of loan.

- 2.4.4 Strengthen the training and capacity building activities for the Community Based Organisations (CBOs) in financial literacy program, like savings, money management, debt management, book keeping, mobile banking, digital payments, preparation of business plan and Government-driven initiatives in banking sectors. The trained members of the CBOs shall in turn reach out to the grassroot level women in need of credit support for their livelihood.

2.5. Industry and Start-ups

The State shall promote women start-ups through initiatives, schemes, creation of enabling networks and activating partnerships among diverse stakeholders in the start-ups eco system with a vision to promote sustainable development of women entrepreneurs.

- 2.5.1 Provide support through Tamil Nadu Start Up Mission exclusively for women led start-ups by way of funding, training, handholding and credit linkages.
- 2.5.2 Provide support through Entrepreneurship Development and Innovation Institute to promote women student innovators and entrepreneurs through Tamil Nadu Student Innovators Program.
- 2.5.3 The Tamil Nadu Start-up and Innovation Policy covers the following aspects:

Supporting social entrepreneurship for a positive social impact and inclusion

Tamil Nadu is a welfare State and social inclusion has been one of the key factors for its sustained growth.

Women

- Prioritize by and for women start-ups
- Training and sensitization programmes for women entrepreneurs.
- Start-ups with women founders or co-founders or firms predominantly with women employees shall be

supported for product development and marketing / Unique Branding to be provided for the products / publicity / participation in fairs and exhibitions.

- Priority in allotment of industrial plots in industrial estates for women start-ups.
- Support for setting up crèche in start-ups/incubators / co-working spaces with more than 50 employees.
- Support to eligible Start-ups addressing issues related to women.

As per Start-up TN-Newsletter December 2022

- Total Number of Start-ups Registered since 2016 – 5,004.
- Total Number of Start-ups Registered in 2022 – 1,805.

2.6 Climate change

Mitigation and management of natural disasters is critical from the gender perspective as floods, droughts etc. impact women severely exposing them to social and economic vulnerabilities.

2.6.1 The State shall adopt holistic gender specific strategies in disaster management and prevention aiming at their safety, well-being, health and rehabilitation.

2.6.2 Environmental friendly, renewable, non-conventional energy, green energy sources shall be promoted and made affordable and accessible to rural households for their basic household activities.

3. Political Empowerment

The State shall strive to establish a gender neutral society where women shall have equal rights in socio-political, economic, cultural and property.

3.1 The State shall aim to promote capacity building for decision making, leadership quality among the elected women representatives of the local bodies.

- 3.2 Elected Women Local Body representatives shall be considered for experiential learning programmes, workshops, field visits, exposure visits shall be organized within and outside the State thereby providing a platform to adopt innovative strategies in their local bodies.
- 3.3 All elected representatives shall be educated and trained to localize and achieve the Sustainable Development Goals.

4. Emotional and Mental Wellbeing

Mental health is a highly gendered issue and analysis of mental health indices and data reveal that symptoms of depression, anxiety and unspecified psychological are 2-3 times more common among women than men. The State shall therefore pay special focus on awareness, counselling, treatment and other interventions to address the challenges of women's mental health.

- 4.1 A community based intervention combined with the District Mental Health Programme shall be initiated. The concerned departments shall follow a systematic approach to provide requisite screening, professional counselling, care and treatment at different levels based on their needs and requirements.
- 4.2 The State shall provide training on basic counselling to the Anganwadi workers, Village Health Nurses etc., community based organization such as Self Help Group (SHG), Panchayat Level Federation (PLF), Village Poverty Reduction Committee (VPRC), Community Professionals to utilize their services to identify women in distress and provide basic counselling support and link them to the professional counsellors.
- 4.3 Necessary steps shall be taken in all educational institutions for providing counselling services to adolescent girls to overcome the issues such as hormonal changes, anxiety due to exams, depression, sexual abuse, domestic violence, suicidal thoughts, etc.

VI. Implementation, Monitoring, Research and Evaluation

The implementation of the policy shall be monitored on a regular basis. Each strategy shall be converted into actionable points which should be measured and followed up intensely.

6.1 Implementation

The objective of this policy will be met through implementation of various initiatives, schemes and programmes by various departments in the Government and participation of various stakeholders and would require coordination and convergence.

Various stakeholding departments shall evolve the schemes in consonance with the objectives of the policy for implementing the same. Detailed Guidelines and required fund allocations will be issued by the concerned departments and they shall ensure that the expected outcomes of the policy are met within the specified policy period. As a continuous exercise the line departments involved shall come out with the plan of action, outlining appropriate achievable indicators.

The Social Welfare and Women Empowerment Department as the anchoring department will facilitate the monitoring of the implementation of the policy.

An implementation monitoring cell will be set up in the office of the Directorate of Social Welfare.

6.2. Monitoring

A High Level Women Empowerment Committee (HLWEC) headed by Chief Secretary including all the line department shall meet once in six months to review the implementation of the policy and suggest mid-term course corrections.

Annual Performance Report of the Policy shall be placed before the Committee.

6.2.1 Similarly District Level Monitoring Committee led by the District Collector shall overview the implementation of the policy once in two months and address the challenges.

6.3 Research

A Gender Observatory (Gen-O) shall be constituted and vested with the responsibility of maintaining a repository of Gender related research done by academic institutions, research bodies, agencies, Government departments for evidence based policy making. Gender budgeting, Gender audit, Gender labs shall be monitored through Gen-O.

6.4 Evaluation

Concurrent evaluation through baseline and end-line surveys of the targeted populations shall be conducted by the third-party agency using qualitative and quantitative methodologies to measure the impact of various interventions done through the policy.

VII. Conclusion

This Policy is valid for a period of 10 years from the date of its notification or till a new policy is formulated. However, amendments in this policy could be made with the approval of the Government without affecting the beneficiaries already covered under the policy. This policy shall be reviewed after five years.

Back drop

The Social Welfare and Nutritious Meal Programme Department of Tamil Nadu was renamed as the Social Welfare and Women Empowerment Department to give additional thrust and indicative of affirmative action related to gender. The present policy has been created based on a widespread consultative process with regional representation from the political parties, civil society organizations, academicians and research institutions. It is to be highlighted that consultations were held with Interagency Expert Group of UN agencies like UNICEF, UNWOMEN, World Bank. Two consultations for the policy were held in Chennai, one in Madurai and one in Coimbatore. Efforts were made to include women and men from different sections to make the policy inclusive that captures the aspirations of the women in the State. The State shall take up programming for synergy, combining multiple strategies and interventions at the individual, interpersonal, community and societal levels for sustained impact. The State shall build innovative initiatives by integrating prevention activities into existing health, development and other sectoral programmes.

Women in Tamil Nadu – A glance

• Women who are literate (%)	84.0 (2020-21, NFHS- 5)
• Women with 10 or more years of schooling (%)	56.6 (2020-21, NFHS- 5)
• Women who have ever used the internet (%)	46.9 (2020-21, NFHS- 5)
• Women aged 20-24 years married before age of 18 years (%)	12.8 (2020-21, NFHS- 5)
• All women age 15-49 years who are anemic (%)	53.4 (2020-21, NFHS- 5)
• All women age 15-19 years who are anemic (%)	52.9 (2020-21, NFHS- 5)
• Women who worked in the last 12 months and paid in cash (%)	40.8
• Women owning a house and/or land (alone /jointly with others) (%)	47.9
• Women having a bank or savings account they themselves use (%)	92.2
• Women having a mobile phone for their own use (%)	74.6

* NHFS: National Family Health Survey - 5

Annexure 3**SOME VITAL GENDER RELATED DATA**

S.No	Indicators	2019 – 2020	Source
1.	Rate of Crimes against women per every 1,00,000 female populations	14.6	SCRB
2.	Conviction rate of crime against Women	18.3	SCRB
3.	Per Lakh women who have been subjected to dowry offences during the year	4.5	SCRB
4.	Conviction rate of women subjected to dowry related offences.	7.7	SCRB
5.	Sex Ratio at Birth (females per 1000males)	942	DPH
6.	Female to male ratio of average wages/salary earning received during the preceding calendar month among regular wage salaried employees (rural + urban)	0.74	PLFS
7.	Proportion of crime against women to total crime reported in the country during the calendar year	1.3	SCRB
8.	Per Lakh women who have experienced sexual crime during the year (in %)	19.9	SCRB
9.	Per Lakh women who have experienced cruelty/Physical violence by husband or her relatives during the calendar year (%)	13.20	SCRB
10.	Conviction rate of cruelty by husband or his relatives	9.4	SCRB
11.	Proportion of sexual crime against girl children to total crime against children during the calendar year	57.3	SCRB
12.	Proportion of Trafficking of girl children to total children trafficked during the calendar year	51	SCRB
13.	Child Sex Ratio (0-6 years) 2011 (per 1000 male births)	943	DPH
14.	Proportion of cases reported under the Prohibition of Child Marriage Act (early marriage of children below 18 years of age)total crime against children, 2015	1.1	SCRB

S.No	Indicators	2019 – 2020	Source
15.	Proportion of seats held by women in national Parliament, State Legislation and Local Self Government – (Assembly)	9.33	State Election
16.	Proportion of seats held by women in national Parliament, State Legislation and Local Self Government – (PRI)	52.99	
17.	Proportion of seats held by women in national Parliament, State Legislation and Local Self Government – (Lok sabha)	7.89	ECI
18.	Proportion of seats held by women in national Parliament, State Legislation and Local Self Government – (Rajya sabha)	11.1	ECI
19.	Female labour force participation rate (LFPR)- Urban areas - (4th Quarter)	24.2	PFLS
20.	Percentage of currently married women (15-49 years) who use modern methods of family planning	68.8	DFW
21.	Operational land holdings – Female (Area in 1000 Hectares)	1036.2	Agri Census
22.	Operational land holdings – Female - Number of holdings (In lakh numbers)	15.60	Agri Census
23.	Agricultural wages (gender wise) – Female	254	DOES
24.	Agricultural wages (gender wise) – Male	277	DOES
25.	Exclusive Women SHGs in Bank linked SHGs (in lakhs)	7.66	TNCDW
26.	Percentage of women employed in IT and ITES industry, 2017-2018	35	TNeGA
27.	Maternal Mortality Ratio GOI	60	SRS
28.	Maternal Mortality Ratio (State)	57	HMIS
29.	Percentage of women aged 15 - 49 years who received antenatal care, four times or more (Period 5 years / 1year) – (Central)	81.1	NFHS
30.	Percentage of women aged 15 - 49 years who received antenatal care, four times or more (Period 5 years/1 year) – (State)	85.49	TN HMIS
31.	Percentage of currently married women (15-49 years) who use any modern family planning methods – (GOI)	52.6	NFHS

S.No	Indicators	2019 – 2020	Source
32.	Percentage of women aged 15-19years who were already mothers or pregnant – (Central)	5	SRS
33.	Percentage of women aged 15-19years who were already mothers or pregnant – (State)	1.16	TNHMIS
34.	Percentage of Institutional Births (5 years / 1 year) – (Central)	98.9	NFHS
35.	Percentage of Institutional Births (5 years / 1 year) – (State)	99.94	TNHMIS
36.	Percentage of people living with HIV currently receiving Anti Retroviral Therapy (ART) among the detected number of adults and children living with HIV	86	TANSACS
37.	Proportion of patients in the target age group (>30 years) in the community who are taking anti- Hypertensive medications in Government Health facilities.	1.7	NHM
38.	Percentage of population in the age group 15-49 who reported sought treatment out of total population in that age group having diabetes.	0.9	NHM
39.	Proportion of patient in the target age group (>30 years) in the community who had been screened for Cervical Cancer atleast once in last three years in Government Health facilities.	40	TNHMIS
40.	significantly reduced all forms of violence and related death rates everywhere	2.2	SCRB
41.	Per One lakh population subjected to Physical, Psychological or sexual violence in previous 12 months	1.4	SCRB
42.	Crime rate of sexual assault on women per lakh population	1.4	SCRB
43.	Conviction rate of reported Murder	29	SCRB

**DETAILS OF VARIOUS ONGOING WOMEN WELFARE PROGRAMMES/
SCHEMES / INITIATIVES MAPPED ACROSS DEPARTMENTS**

Sl. No.	DEPARTMENT	PROGRAMMES / SCHEMES / INITIATIVES
1.	Social Welfare and Women Empowerment	- Moovalur Ramamirtham Ammaiyar Higher Education Assurance Scheme (MRAHEAS) - Pudhumai Pen Thittam. - Free Travel Concession for women in Government run White Board buses. - Cradle Baby Scheme - Chief Minister's Girl Child Protection Scheme - Beti Bacho Beti Padhao (BBBP) (Shared Scheme) - Suganya Samrithi Yojana - Marriage Assistance Schemes (4) - Dr.Muthulakshmi Reddy Ammaiyar Memorial Inter-caste Marriage Assistance Scheme. - Dr.Dharmambal Ammaiyar Memorial Widow Remarriage Assistance Scheme. - E.V.R.Maniammaiyar Memorial Widow's Daughter Marriage Assistance Scheme. - Annai Theresa Memorial Orphan Girls Marriage Assistance Scheme. - Sathyavani Muthu Ammaiyar Free Sewing Machine Scheme. - Women Industrial Co-operative Societies. - Hub for Empowerment of Women at State and District Level. - Gender Budget Cells in Departments - Shakti Sadan (Swadhar Greh and Ujjawala Homes)

		• Government Service Homes. • Working Women Hostels. • One Stop Centres (OSC) • Family Counseling Centres • Help Lines a) Women Help Line - 181 b) Child Help Line - 1098 c) Elder Help Line - 14567 • Chief Minister Breakfast Scheme • Integrated Child Development Services Scheme a) Supplementary Nutrition Programme (ICDS) b) Complementary Feeding (Sathu Mavu) c) Hot Cooked Nutrition Meal d) Uttasathai Uruthi Sei - Ensure Nutrition to All e) Mission POSHAN 2.0 f) People's Mass Movement (Jan Andolan) g) Provision of Medicine kit and Hygiene kit h) Scheme for Adolescent girls (SAG) i) National Creche Scheme • Mid-Day Meal • National Mid day Meal Scheme (PM - POSHAN) • Supply of Hygiene kit to Nutritious Meal Centre • Fortification of Rice (Pilot Project) • Community Bangle Ceremony • Children Homes • Open Shelters for Children in need of care and protection (Urban and Semi-urban Areas) • Financial Assistance under Chief Minister's Public Relief Fund (CMPRF) • The Tamil Nadu Child Victim Compensation Fund under the Protection of Children from Sexual
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		Offences (POCSO) Act, 2012. • Sponsorship Assistance Programme • State Level Annual Sports and Cultural Meet • Children Educational Tour Scheme • Child Adoption • Special Homes (Long term Rehabilitation Programme for children in conflict with law) • Child Protection Services - GOI Sponsored Programmes • Vigilance and Protective Homes • Various Social Legislations • Social Security Pension Schemes
2	Rural Development and Panchayat Raj Institutions	• Tamil Nadu Corporation for Development of Women - Promotion of Self Help Group movement since 1989. • Tamil Nadu State Rural Livelihood Mission (TNRLM) • Tamil Nadu Urban Livelihood Mission (TNULM) • National Rural Economic Transformation Project (NRETP) • Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Grameen Kaushalya Yojana (DDUGKY) (60:40 - Placement linked skill development programme.
3	Health	• Dr.Muthulakshmi Reddy Maternity Benefit Scheme (MRMBS) • Amma Baby Care Kit • Breast Milk Banks • Lactation Rooms in bus stands / terminals

		• Menstrual Hygiene Programme (Supply of priceless sanitary Napkins) • Community Bangle Ceremony • 108 Emergency Ambulance Services • Tamil Nadu State Aids Control Society (TNSACS) - to reduce new infections and facilitate comprehensive care, support and treatment all persons living with HIV / AIDS and working towards, • Makkalai Thedi Maruthuvam
4	Education	• Scholarship Schemes for girls students. • 7.5 Internal Reservation for Higher Education for both Boys and Girls • Illam Thedi Kalvi - A volunteer based teaching programme • Ennum Yezhuthum - A pedagogy designed teaching programme.
5	Police	• First State in the entire country to setup All Women Police Station. • About 40% of All Women Police Stations in the Country are located in Tamil Nadu. • The State has 1/4 of All Women Sub-Inspectors in the Country. • Overall, Tamil Nadu accounts of 1/7 of All Women Police Personnel in India. • 800 Women Help Desks are functioning in Tamil Nadu. A vehicle and lap top have been provided to these Women Help Desk units through the Nirbhaya Fund.

		• Emergency Response Support System / Kaaval Udhavi Mobile App. • 'forensic' DNA profile search Tool' developed by the State Forensic Sciences Department (Tamil Nadu is the first State to develop)
6	Law	• 20 Special courts are functioning across the State for exclusive trial of cases registered under The Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act 2012 • 32 Family Courts are functioning in the State to promote conciliation and secure speedy settlement of disputes relating to marriage and family affairs. 7 additional courts and 4 Holiday Family Courts are functioning in Chennai and one additional Family court at Coimbatore. • 10 Magaliar Neethimandram (Mahila Courts) are functioning in the State for exclusive trial of cases of crime against women. • 32 additional Mahila Court at Judicial Magistrate level is functioning for trial of case pertaining to cruelty against women. • 22 Fast Track Mahila Court are functioning in the State. • The special court functioning at Coimbatore District tries the Protection of Women from Domestic Violence, Act 2005.
7	Transport	• State has launched Artificial Intelligence Enabled 'Panic Button' and CCTV Cameras in 500 buses as 1st phase as a part of an initiative to improve Women Safety and Security Through Nirbhaya

		Safe City Project • Free Transport Facility to Women and Transgender to enhance their mobility and promote more women participants in work force.
8	MSME	• 5% Additional Capital Subsidy for Women Entrepreneurs with a 50% target for first generation entrepreneurs to encourage women start-ups and enterprises.

LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS

Sl. No.	Abbreviations	Details
1.	ANM	Auxiliary Nurse Mid-wife
2.	ASHA	Accredited Social Health Activist
3.	AWH	Anganwadi Helper
4.	AWW	Anganwadi Worker
5.	CRP	Community Resource Person
6.	CPs	Community Professionals
7.	DOES	Department of Economics and Statistics
8.	DPHPM	Directorate of Public Health and Preventive Medicine
9.	ECI	Election Commission of India
10.	ERSS	Emergency Response Support System
11.	FLFPR	Female Labour Force Participation Rate
12.	HIV	Human Immunodeficiency Virus
13.	ICDS	Integrated Child Development Services
14.	JJ Act	Juvenile Justice (Care and Protection of Children) Act, 2015
15.	NFHS	National Family Health Survey
16.	PLFS	Periodic Labour Force Survey
17.	PNC	Post Natal Care
18.	POSH Act	Protection of Women against Sexual Harassment at Work Place (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013
19.	SCRB	State Crime Record Bureau
20.	SHGs	Self Help Groups

LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS

Sl. No.	Abbreviations	Details
21.	SRS	Sample Registration System
22.	STEM	Science, Technology, Engineering, Mathematics
23.	TANSAC	Tamil Nadu Aids Control Society
24.	TNHMIS	Tamil Nadu Health Management Information System
25.	NHM	National Health Mission
26.	UN Women	United Nation Women
27.	UNICEF	United Nations Children's Fund
28.	VPRC	Village Poverty Reduction Committee

LIST OF WELFARE BOARDS

Sl. No.	Details
1.	Widows and Destitute Women Welfare Board
2.	Tamil Nadu Labour Welfare Board
3.	Tamil Nadu Unorganized Worker Welfare Board
4.	Tamil Nadu Narikoravar Welfare Board
5.	Tamil Nadu Urban Habitat Development Board
6.	Tamil Nadu Housing Board (TNHB)
7.	Tamil Nadu Infrastructure & Development Board (TNIDB)
8.	Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board (TNPCB)
9.	Tamil Nadu Kadhi & Village Industries Board (TNKVIB)
10.	Tamil Nadu State Agriculture Marketing Board (TNSAMB)
11.	Tamil Nadu Fishermen Welfare Board
12.	Differently Abled Welfare Board

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1924-2023



Tamil Nadu State Policy for Women 2024



Social Welfare and Women Empowerment Department

